



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Crossville Christian School
School Website: <https://www.cacknights.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Crossville Christian School Tn 38555 (operating as Christian Academy of the Cumberlands on the CAC site) presents a strongly religiously grounded program, with explicit Christian theology, biblical worldview integration, and clear partnership with families. Public-facing materials emphasize Christ-centered formation, biblical instruction, and a partnership with parents; there is explicit mention of a Statement of Faith and a biblically-based mission. However, the school's public materials do not clearly articulate a classical curriculum or pedagogy in the sense described by the classical school rubric (e.g., explicit reference to Great Books, grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, or Socratic inquiry in the upper grades). The curriculum appears to hinge on a Christian worldview and a predefined Christian curriculum (ABEKA) rather than a traditional liberal-arts focus. Taken together, Crossville Christian School Tn 38555 demonstrates clear Classical affinities in religious foundations and parental/community integration, modest Classical alignment in pedagogy and faculty orientation, but relatively weak Classical signal in explicit curriculum structure and high-school Socratic/seminar traditions. Overall, the school is BEST described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Key highlights - Strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: explicit theology, biblical worldview, Statement of Faith, and Christ-centered framing permeate mission and program materials.

- Clear School Purpose aligned with formation and faith integration, though with explicit emphasis on college/career readiness as a current priority in practice. - Curriculum oriented around Biblical instruction and Christian worldview (ABEKA-based materials), with limited public emphasis on Great Books or liberal-arts canonical study. - Pedagogy appears more traditional/instructional (ABEKA-driven) rather than explicitly Classical (few references to Socratic seminars, great-books pedagogy, or memory-centered scholé in public content). - Faculty presence is documented (staff/faculty page, accreditation), but the public materials do not foreground the "living curriculum" or "portrait of teacher" mindset characteristic of some classical schools. - Parents and Community are positioned as partners and co-educators, with visible emphasis on home–school alignment and parental involvement.

What would move the needle: concrete steps to reach CLASSICAL - Expand curriculum to explicitly include liberal-arts elements: integrate grammar–logic–rhetoric progression (even if in a Christian context), include a canon of classical literature or Great Books selections, and emphasize history as Western civilization through primary texts. - Adopt explicit classical pedagogy in upper grades: introduce Socratic discussions, seminars, and rhetoric-focused assessment; incorporate memory-driven recitation and disciplined oral expression as formal components. - Enhance the "living curriculum" and teacher portrait: articulate a formal faculty development plan grounded in classical pedagogy and publish a clearly defined "teacher profile" that aligns with classical formation goals. - Increase explicit Great Conversation and wonder: add experiences of intellectual awe, cross-disciplinary inquiry, and opportunities for students to engage with enduring questions and texts beyond standard Christian curricula. - Deepen parent formation and involvement in classical aims: expand book studies, parent seminars, and visible open-campus opportunities to involve families in the Great Conversation and classical formation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Materials foreground a distinctly Christian framework: biblical worldview, biblical instruction, and Christ-centered education are repeatedly emphasized in mission statements and doctrinal notes. For example, CAC's mission describes developing students with a Christian worldview through biblically-based teaching, and a Statement of Faith anchors authority to Scripture.

- Calls to integrate God's truth across life and learning are explicit, indicating transcendental aims and moral formation. Public materials present a clear theology-centered education rather than a secular epistemology.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: truth/true, God, biblical worldview, theology, Word of God, Christ-centered, Scripture, faith-based. Representative matches include "biblical worldview," "Statement of Faith," "Word of God," and "Christ-centered home, church, and school" language. - Negative indicators: none evident in public materials (no explicit calls to secular or relativist approaches). The absence of secular framing strengthens the religious foundation signal.

Why this rating - The school's public communications strongly affirm theological grounding and communal worship-oriented sensibilities, which align with the Positive keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. There is limited indication of secular or relativist framing, so the category reads as CLASSICAL-adjacent in its religious/metaphysical orientation, with room to more fully realize the classical elements (e.g., liturgical practices) in public-facing materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes forming the whole student within a Christian worldview, with biblically-based teaching and service aims. It calls for equipping the next generation in service to the Lord and others. This aligns with formation and virtue-centered aims rather than purely utilitarian outcomes. - The curriculum and mission also mention preparation for college and career, indicating a balancing of formation with workforce/career aims (a modern emphasis that some classical promoters would view as a potential tension). The public materials note the aim to prepare for college and career as part of the program.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, liberal education (conceptual alignment), Christian worldview, classical mission, telos, true/good/beautiful, contemplation (where mentioned), Great Conversation (not explicitly named, but the formation aims reflect similar aims in a Christian frame). - Negative indicators present: explicit emphasis on college/career preparation noted within the public materials, which can be seen as a modern workforce emphasis that some classical-sector criteria flag as a departure from formation-centric aims. This is evidenced by language about continuing to prepare for college and career.

Why this rating - The school prioritizes formation, virtue, and a Christian telos, which aligns with classical aims; however, the public materials also emphasize college/career readiness as a practical outcome, which drags the category toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. The absence (so far) of explicit Great Conversation framing (canonical canon, classical telos) also tempers the rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described in terms of Bible, Language Arts, Math, Science, and History, with explicit mention of the ABEKA program as the foundational curricular approach. This signals a Biblically-based Christian curriculum rather than the liberal-arts canon approach typical of classical programs. - There is no explicit mention of liberal arts fundamentals (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, or the Great Conversation, nor of canonical Western texts or Latin/Greek (public-facing materials do not articulate these elements). - The school does emphasize a biblical worldview across the curriculum, but the absence of Great Books, classical languages, or a triad of grammar/logic/rhetoric signals a non-classical curricular structure.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: Bible-based instruction; biblical worldview; foundational Christian curriculum; explicit mention of "biblically-based teaching." These align with the religious

dimension of curriculum but not with classical liberal-arts structure. - Negative indicators: Lack of reference to Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, canonical texts, or the Trivium/Quadrivium framework. There is also no explicit history-integration across disciplines as a Great Books approach. Positive mentions of a Christian curriculum are present, but this is not the same as “classical” curriculum signals.

Why this rating - Given the strong Christian emphasis but the absence of classical-curriculum markers (Great Books, grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, canonical texts), the category is NOT CLASSICAL according to the strict six-element rubric.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe an ABEKA-based curriculum and mention live instruction and discussion in some classes, often with video-based instruction in others. This suggests a structured, teacher-led program rather than a distinctly Classical pedagogy built on Socratic seminars, memory work, and Scholé practices. - There is no explicit public articulation of Socratic seminars, classical memory work, or rhetoric training in the public-facing materials. The absence of these classical pedagogical markers (Socratic dialogue, memorization via dictation, or regular Seminars) supports a non-classical pedagogy reading.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: Some mention of live instruction and discussion in some classes; a structured, teacher-led approach. These align with traditional pedagogy but not with classical pedagogy per se (which would emphasize memory work, recitation, and Socratic dialogue more explicitly). - Negative indicators: Absence of core Classical pedagogical signals in the public content: Scholé (restful learning), memory work, recitation, chanting, Socratic seminars, Paideia-style dialogue, or upper-grade rhetoric track. The classical lexicon identifies these as hallmark practices, which are not evident here.

Why this rating - The school demonstrates a structured, faith-integrated pedagogy but lacks explicit classical teaching methods in public materials. Therefore, NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials show a staff/faculty roster and accreditation, indicating a professional, credentialed teaching staff. However, the content does not foreground the living-curriculum concept or a formal teacher-formation profile in the way classical schools often do (e.g., teacher portraits, long-term mentoring, or classical formation pathways). - The emphasis on Christian formation and a family-partnered approach implies teachers are expected to model virtue and serve as part of the broader Christian formation. The explicit language highlighting a Christian worldview and biblically based teaching implies teachers serve as mentors within a faith-centered framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: model-teacher/mentor ethos (implied by emphasis on formation and partnership with families), credentialed staff, alignment with accreditation (ACSI). The explicit “portrait of a teacher” or “living curriculum” language is not visible in public content, but the formation emphasis suggests teacher role-modeling. - Negative indicators: The public materials do not emphasize the classical teacher profile or “living curriculum” as found in classical-school statements.

Why this rating - The faculty appears credible and mission-aligned, and the school emphasizes formation. However, the lack of explicit classical-faculty descriptors or a formal “living curriculum” portrait places it in the middle ground. Thus SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school presents partnership with parents as foundational, with language describing education as a partnership between parents and school; parental involvement is encouraged, and there are materials dedicated to parent formation (handbooks, family alignment). This aligns with the classical emphasis on parental cooperation and formation of the whole family. - The materials discuss a Christ-centered

home—church—school network and welcome parental engagement and visits, reflecting the “parents as co-teachers” and “open campus” ethos that classical models often promote.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: partnership with parents, parental formation/education opportunities (handbooks, seminars implied by parent formation), open-campus-friendly language (visits). - Negative indicators: None evident in public communications; no minimal-parent involvement described as a consumer model; rather, the materials frame parents as co-educators.

Why this rating - The school clearly prioritizes a collaborative parental role and family engagement, matching classical signals for Parents & Community.

What Would Move the Needle

- Make explicit the classical curriculum elements: publish and implement a formal plan that foregrounds grammar—logic—rhetoric progression, Great Books or canonical texts, and a clear Trivium/Quadrivium orientation within the curriculum.
- Adopt explicit Classical Pedagogy: incorporate Socratic seminars, disciplined memory work or recitations, and scholé-informed pauses; articulate a clear upper-grade rhetoric/declamation pathway.
- Elevate the living-curriculum concept: publish a formal teacher-profile/portrait, faculty formation plans, and visible demonstrations of teacher-led classical practice in classrooms.
- Deepen Great Conversation and wonder: weave regular cross-disciplinary inquiries into major topics, promoting wonder and awe in learning.
- Expand parent formation to classical lines: widen book-studies for parents, host regular classical-education seminars, and create structured opportunities for parent involvement in canonical reading and discussions.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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